

Absolutely — here is the **redone comprehensive entry for *shell***, with the omitted computing, scientific, corporate, and figurative branches integrated properly rather than tacked on afterward.

Word family: **shell / shells / shelled / shelling / shellfish**

Base word: shell

Plural: shells

Past tense: shelled

Past participle: shelled

-ing form: shelling

Useful related/compound forms: shellfish, shell company, shell script

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “I remember the greenish **shell**, the gentle eyes, and the quiet rhythm of its body...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **shell** means the **hard protective outer covering of certain animals**, specifically the turtle’s protective body covering.

繁體中文： **某些動物身上堅硬、用來保護身體的外殼；殼 / 甲殼**

中文翻譯：

> “I remember the greenish **shell**...”

「我還記得牠帶點綠色的**龜殼 / 甲殼**.....」

Here:

turtle shell = 海龜身上堅硬、具有保護作用的外殼

1. **shell = hard protective outer covering (動植物 / 食物) — 殼；甲殼；硬殼**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A hard outer covering that protects an animal, egg, nut, seed, or similar thing.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I remember the turtle’s greenish **shell**.”

「我還記得海龜帶點綠色的**龜殼**。」

Practice 2

> “The snail disappeared into its **shell**.”

「蝸牛縮回自己的**殼**裡。」

Practice 3

> “There was a crack in the egg **shell**.”

「蛋**殼**上有一道裂縫。」

****shell = 包圍並保護裡面部分的堅硬外層****

Common:

- * turtle shell
- * snail shell
- * crab shell
- * egg shell / eggshell
- * nut shell / nutshell
- * seashell

The exact object changes, but the underlying concept remains:

> ****hard protective casing****

So these should remain one core sense.

2. ****shell = outer casing or structural exterior (物件 / 建築) — 外殼 ; 殼體 ; 骨架****

****Shell**** can mean the outer structure of an object, machine, vehicle, building, etc., especially when the inside is separate, empty, unfinished, or less important.

Practice 4

> “The laptop has a lightweight metal **shell**.”

「這部手提電腦有一個輕巧的金屬**外殼**。」

Practice 5

> “Only the **shell** of the building remained after the fire.”

「火災後只剩下建築物的**外殼 / 骨架**。」

shell = 某個物件或建築物包圍內部的外層結構

Common:

- * outer shell
- * protective shell
- * building shell
- * device shell
- * helmet shell

This develops directly from the literal animal-shell concept:

> protective hard outside → structural outer casing

3. **shell** = empty outer form with little substance inside (比喻) — 空殼；徒具形式的東西

This important figurative use should be made explicit.

Meaning: Something whose external structure or formal existence remains, but whose original substance, activity, strength, or content has largely disappeared.

Practice 6

> “After years of neglect, the organization was only a **shell** of its former self.”

「經過多年忽視後，那個組織已經只剩昔日的**空殼**。」

Practice 7

> “The old town centre became a **shell** after most businesses moved away.”

「大部分商店搬走後，舊市中心變得只剩一個**空殼**。」

shell = 外在形式仍存在，但內部實質內容、力量或功能已大幅減少

This is conceptually close to Meaning 2, but important enough for learners to show separately because it supports several major modern compounds.

Important compound: **shell company / shell corporation — 空殼公司**

A **shell company** is a legally existing company that has little or no substantial active business operation of its own.

Practice 8

> “The assets were held through several **shell companies**.”

「那些資產透過幾間**空殼公司**持有。」

Practice 9

> “The investigation examined whether the business was merely a **shell company**.”

「調查檢視該企業是否只是一間**空殼公司**。」

shell company = 法律上存在，但本身幾乎沒有實際營運、員工或重大業務活動的公司

Important nuance:

A shell company is **not automatically illegal**. Such companies may have legitimate structural or financial purposes, although they can also be misused.

Semantically:

- > company structure exists
- > but substantial operating content may be absent

So this belongs under:

- > **empty outer form / structural shell**

rather than creating a completely separate core meaning.

4. **shell = ammunition / explosive projectile (軍事) — 炮彈；彈藥殼體**

A **shell** can mean an explosive projectile fired from artillery or, in some contexts, an ammunition casing.

Practice 10

> “The museum displayed an old artillery **shell**.”

「博物館展示了一枚舊式**炮彈**。」

Practice 11

> “Empty **shells** were found nearby.”

「附近找到一些空的**彈殼**。」

****shell** = 炮彈，或某些語境中指彈藥的金屬外殼

Useful distinctions include:

- * artillery shell → 炮彈
- * shell casing → 彈殼
- * shotgun shell → 霰彈槍彈

This is a genuinely distinct noun branch.

5. ****shell** = command interface in computing (電腦) — 殼層；命令列介面

This was one of the important omissions in the earlier entry.

In computing, a ****shell**** is a program/interface through which a user gives commands to an operating system or interacts with system functions.

Practice 12

> “Open a ****shell**** and run the command.”

「開啟一個****命令列介面 / shell****，然後執行指令。」

Practice 13

> “The script runs inside a Unix ****shell****.”

「這個腳本在 Unix ****shell / 殼層****中執行。」

****shell** = 使用者與作業系統核心功能之間的命令 / 操作介面

Common:

- * Unix shell
- * command shell
- * shell command

* shell script

This is a well-established computing sense and deserves its own core entry.

Useful compound: **shell script — shell 腳本**

A **shell script** is a file containing commands designed to be executed by a command shell.

Practice 14

> “He wrote a short **shell script** to automate the task.”

「他寫了一個簡短的 **shell 腳本**來自動完成這項工作。」

This belongs to the computing sense.

6. **shell = electron/atomic layer (物理 / 化學) — 電子層 ; 電子殼層**

In atomic science, a **shell** is a major energy level or region associated with electrons around an atomic nucleus.

Practice 15

> “Electrons occupy different **shells** around the nucleus.”

「電子分布在原子核周圍不同的**電子層 / 電子殼層**。」

Practice 16

> “The outer **shell** contains the atom’s outermost electrons.”

「最外層**電子殼層**包含原子的最外層電子。」

electron shell = 原子中電子按能量層級分布所形成的電子層

The metaphor is again:

> layers surrounding a central core

This is a legitimate scientific domain sense.

7. **shell = hollow food casing/container (食物) — 餅殼；硬殼狀容器**

In food contexts, **shell** can mean a hollow or firm edible casing intended to hold a filling.

Practice 17

> “Fill the pastry **shells** with cream.”

「把忌廉加入酥皮**餅殼**中。」

Practice 18

> “The taco **shell** broke when I picked it up.”

「我拿起玉米餅時，taco 的脆**外殼**裂開了。」

Common:

* pastry shell

* taco shell

* pie shell

This is best treated as an extension of the **outer casing** sense rather than an independent core concept.

8. **shell = remove the shell from something (動詞) — 剝殼；去殼**

As a verb, **shell** means to remove the shell or pod from food.

Practice 19

> “She **shelled** the peas before cooking them.”

「她煮豌豆之前先把它們**去殼**。」

Practice 20

> “We spent the afternoon **shelling** nuts.”

「我們下午一直在給堅果**剝殼**。」

shell something = 把某種食物、堅果、豆類等外面的殼除去

This is a genuinely distinct verb meaning.

9. **shell = bombard with artillery (動詞) — 炮擊；轟擊**

As a military verb, **shell** means to fire artillery shells at a place.

Practice 21

> “The position was heavily **shelled**.”

「那個陣地遭到猛烈**炮擊**。」

Practice 22

> “The town was **shelled** during the fighting.”

「那個城鎮在戰鬥期間遭到**炮擊**。」

shell a place = 用炮彈對某地進行轟擊

This belongs to the ammunition branch but is a distinct verb use.

10. **shell = psychological protection / emotional withdrawal (比喻) — 心理外殼；封閉狀態**

The physical protective shell creates an important metaphor for personality.

A person can be imagined as hiding inside a protective shell when they are shy, withdrawn, or emotionally guarded.

Practice 23

> “After the argument, he retreated into his **shell**.”

「爭吵後，他變得更加**封閉、不願與人交流**。」

Practice 24

> “She slowly began to come out of her **shell**.”

「她慢慢開始**放開自己、不再那麼害羞封閉**。」

shell = 比喻人用來保護自己、避免情感或社交接觸的心理屏障

For strict counting, this remains a figurative extension of Meaning 1 rather than a new core bare-word sense.

Fixed expression: **come out of your shell — 不再害羞；變得開朗**

Practice 25

> “He came out of his **shell** after joining the group.”

「加入小組後，他逐漸**不再害羞，變得更開朗**。」

come out of your shell = 從原本害羞、封閉、不願社交的狀態變得較開放

Fixed expression: **retreat into your shell — 退縮；變得封閉**

Practice 26

> “She tends to retreat into her **shell** when she feels criticized.”

「她覺得受批評時往往會**退縮、封閉自己**。」

These belong to the emotional-protection metaphor.

Fixed expression: **shell game — 障眼法；騙局**

Originally, a **shell game** is a trick/game in which a small object is hidden under one of several shells or cups and moved around.

Figuratively, it can mean deceptive manipulation intended to conceal where something really is or what is really happening.

Practice 27

> “The arrangement looked like a financial **shell game**.”

「這種安排看起來像一場財務上的**障眼法 / 騙局**。」

shell game = 利用轉移、隱藏或混淆來欺騙別人的手法

This is an idiom/compound, not another meaning of bare **shell**.

Phrasal verb: **shell out** — 花一大筆錢

Practice 28

> “We had to **shell out** for the repairs.”

「我們不得不為維修**花一大筆錢**。」

Practice 29

> “He shelled out hundreds of dollars for the ticket.”

「他為那張票**花了數百美元**。」

shell out = 不情願或明顯地付出一筆錢

However, according to our operating procedure, phrasal verbs are **excluded by default** unless specifically needed for the target sentence. So this should be recorded separately rather than counted in the core **shell** entry.

Related form: **shellfish**

Shellfish refers broadly to aquatic animals such as crustaceans and molluscs that are conventionally grouped together as seafood.

Practice 30

> “The restaurant serves fresh **shellfish**.”

「這間餐廳供應新鮮**甲殼類 / 貝類海鮮**。」

shellfish = 通常作為海鮮分類的甲殼類及軟體動物

Important:

shellfish are not simply “fish with shells” biologically.

The word is a conventional lexical category.

Lower-priority specialist uses

A comprehensive second pass also finds a few legitimate but lower-priority uses.

**shell = lightweight racing boat (賽艇) **

In rowing, a **shell** can mean a narrow racing boat.

> “The rowers carried the racing shell to the water.”

「划艇運動員把狹長的比賽**賽艇**搬到水邊。」

This is legitimate but specialized enough that I would **not promote it into the main learner core count**.

Important distinction: **shell vs skin**

shell

= hard outer covering

skin

= softer flexible outer layer

> turtle shell

> human skin

So:

shell = 硬殼

skin = 皮膚 / 外皮

Important distinction: **shell vs case**

case

is a general protective container or covering and may be removable.

shell

often suggests the hard structural outside itself.

> phone case

often removable.

> laptop shell

part of the device's outer construction.

Important distinction: **shell vs husk**

shell

= hard casing

husk

= dry, fibrous or leafy outer layer of certain grains, seeds, or fruits

> nut shell

> corn husk

Important distinction: **shell vs peel**

peel

usually refers to the softer skin of fruit or vegetables.

shell

usually refers to a harder casing.

> orange peel

> egg shell

Important distinction: **shell vs armour**

shell

names the natural anatomical covering itself.

armour

describes something whose purpose is protection against attack or damage.

A turtle's shell acts as natural armour, but **shell** is the anatomical term.

Important distinction: **shell company vs ordinary company**

A **shell company** has corporate/legal existence but little or no substantial operating activity of its own.

An ordinary operating company generally has active:

- * business operations
- * employees
- * products/services
- * customers or revenue-generating activity

The word **shell** therefore emphasizes:

> **legal/external structure without much operating substance inside**

Important distinction: **computer shell vs operating system**

operating system

is the larger system managing hardware, applications, files, memory, etc.

shell

is an interface through which commands or instructions can be given to the system.

So:

> shell ≠ entire operating system

It is one layer/interface within the computing environment.

Countability note

Most noun meanings are countable:

- > a shell
- > two shells

Examples:

- * a turtle shell
- * an artillery shell
- * an electron shell
- * a Unix shell

But expressions such as ****shellfish**** follow their own number behaviour:

- > one shellfish
- > several shellfish

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * ****shell****
- * ****shells****
- * ****shelled****
- * ****shelling****

Useful lexical/compound extensions include:

- * shellfish
- * shell company
- * shell corporation
- * shell script
- * shell command
- * electron shell
- * pastry shell
- * taco shell
- * shell game

Fixed expressions include:

- * come out of your shell

* retreat into your shell

Separate phrasal verb:

* shell out

The Golden Manual requires a broad second pass specifically to **catch missed modern uses** while also merging artificial overlaps². That is especially important here: computing **shell** and electron **shell** deserve explicit coverage, while compounds such as **shell company** should be shown without falsely inflating the core sense count.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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shell — hard protective covering	動物、蛋、堅果等外面堅硬、具有保護作用的殼 / 甲殼
shell — structural outer casing	建築、機器、裝置等包圍內部的外層結構 / 外殼
shell — empty outer form	外在形式仍存在，但內部實質內容、活動或力量已大幅減少的空殼
shell company	法律上存在，但本身幾乎沒有實際營運或重大業務活動的空殼公司
shell — ammunition	炮彈，或某些語境中的彈藥殼體
shell — computing	使用者透過命令與作業系統功能互動的介面 / 殼層
shell — electron layer	原子中電子按能量層級分布的電子層 / 電子殼層
shell — edible casing	用來包住餡料或內容物的硬 / 中空食物外殼；屬於 casing 義
shell — verb, remove casing	把豆類、堅果等的外殼除去
shell — verb, bombard	用炮彈轟擊某個地方
shell — emotional metaphor	比喻封閉、保護自己、不願讓別人接近內心的心理狀態
shell game	透過轉移和隱藏造成混淆的騙局 / 障眼法
shellfish	甲殼類及軟體動物等傳統海鮮分類

For your original sentence

> “I remember the greenish **shell**, the gentle eyes...”

The exact meaning is:

shell = 海龜身上堅硬、用來保護身體的外殼

So:

> **the turtle's shell**

= **海龜的龜殼 / 甲殼**

For your database, after the comprehensive second-pass audit, I would count **7 genuinely useful core meanings** for **shell**:

1. **hard protective outer covering**
2. **outer casing / structural shell**
3. **empty outer form with little substance remaining**
4. **ammunition shell / casing**
5. **computing shell**
6. **scientific electron/atomic shell**
7. **verb family — remove a shell / bombard with shells**

For the verb family, I would still store the two verb branches separately inside #7 because **shell peas** and **shell a town** require completely different learner concepts.

I would keep **shell company** under #3, **pastry/taco shell** under #2, emotional **shell** under #1/#3 as a metaphor, and **come out of your shell, shell game**, and **shell out** as fixed or phrasal extensions rather than artificially expanding the core count.